Wander is a online map service app that allows users to save their favorite places around the world.

BACKGROUND

Since I am passionate about user interface design and UI processes, I set out to create a UI case study of the Wander app and in Design as part of that study. The goal was for me to learn prototyping and testing tools and implement them into a project. Wander is a simple full-stack app that we built as a team during a web development bootcamp.

TIMELINE & TARGET

3 WEEKS
PORTFOLIO PROJECT

TOOLS

Figma, Miro, Maze

APPROACH & METHODS

1. RESEARCH → 2. IDEALIZATION → 3. TESTING → 4. FINAL DESIGN

- 1. RESEARCH: COMPARE SIMILAR APPS, TESTING DEFINITION, INTERVIEWING THE USERS, PERSONAS, USER FLOWS / TASKS
- 2. IDEALIZATION: USER INTERVIEWS, DESIGNING, PROTOTYPING / FLOWS, TESTING SAMPLE / DATA
- 3. TESTING: USER TESTING / MEDIO, FEEDBACK FROM PROJECT, TESTING SAMPLE / DATA
- 4. FINAL DESIGN: PRODUCT VISION, CONCLUSION, TAKE AWAY

Research · Realization · Testing · Feedback

STATUS ANALYSE

I looked at Wander's features and design and compared it to similar applications to make a more meaningful suggestion for improvement.

PROBLEM ANALYSIS

Users who would like to share their places and thoughts and experiences can't because Wander doesn't offer such features. I compared similar apps and found that Mapiri offers exactly this main function for saving favorite places. So I wondered how Wander would position itself against the competition if it were a real app ?

COMPARE SIMILAR APPS

BENEFITS	WANDER	INSTAGRAM	MAPIRI	TRIPADVIS.
ADD FAVORITE SPOTS TO MAP & LIST		●	●	
STORIES				
CHAT	●			
LOCATIONBASED	●	●	●	●
PROPOSED	●	●	◐	●
PERSONAL WARNINGS	●		◐	●
POCKET	◐			

MY SOLUTION

We all love stories and experiencing places. I believe Wander will attract more users with interactive features by becoming a social media platform.

Besides a new design, I propose to equip Wander with 3 new features. Users can share their unique map with friends, family and the whole world and post their experiences in the form of stories. They can get inspired to visit a place while getting bundled information about that spot, as all the stories Wander users have ever written about that location can be quickly found. With a Pocket feature, Wander can better differentiate itself from the competition by also storing external links, such as posts, podcasts, videos about a place. This makes tracking and scheduling with Wander very easy and fast without having to sort manually to find desired content quickly.

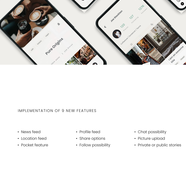
TESTING DEFINITION

To test whether my proposal would result in Wander getting more users as a real world application, I created a prototype and then tested it with real users using an online testing tool to get feedback. I wanted to find out what percentage of test subjects would say they would use Wander if they could share their favorite places and stories. Another part of the test was to find out which parts of the user interface should be simplified to make it fun to use.

Research · Realization · Testing · Feedback

REDESIGN AND PROTOTYPING

The responsive prototype was created with Figma. This resulted in a total of 8 new features and 33 frames, all connected and clickable in the Figma presentation as if it were a real application to get the most real test results. During the design process, I ran A/B tests on Instagram to make better design decisions.



IMPLEMENTATION OF 8 NEW FEATURES

- News feed
- Location feed
- Pocket feature
- Profile feed
- Share options
- Follow possibility
- Chat possibility
- Picture upload
- Private or public stories

COMPARE SIMILAR APPS WITH NEW FEATURES

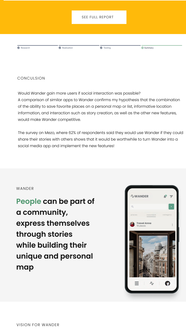
BENEFITS	WANDER	INSTAGRAM	MAPIRI	TRIPADVIS.
ADD FAVORITE SPOTS TO MAP & LIST		●	●	
STORIES		●		
CHAT	●	●		
LOCATIONBASED	●	●	●	●
PROPOSED	●	●	◐	●
PERSONAL WARNINGS	●		◐	●
POCKET	●			

Research · Realization · Testing · Feedback

TESTING RESULTS

Maze enables the creation of user tests for prototypes.
13 test subjects participated. The test for Wander consisted of 13 steps.
3 tasks where testers had to search for and access a specific function, and 3 subsequent questions about how easy it was for them to complete that task. 3 questions about the features themselves and how they interacted with social media, and one question about the test survey.

The test found that 82% of testers said they were more likely to use Wander to share their stories with friends and family, and 82% to discover new places.



Research · Realization · Testing · Feedback

CONCLUSION

Would Wander gain more users if social interaction was possible?
A comparison of similar apps to Wander confirms my hypothesis that the combination of the ability to save favorite places on a personal map as list, informative location information, and interaction such as story creation, as well as the other new features, would make Wander competitive.

The survey on Maze, where 92% of respondents said they would use Wander if they could share their stories with others shows that it would be worthwhile to turn Wander into a social media app and implement the new features.

WANDER

People can be part of a community, express themselves through stories while building their unique and personal map

VISION FOR WANDER

Creating personas revealed a potential new audience. Business owners who would love to read stories about their establishments and want more contact with guests to let them know about activities and events would certainly enjoy enhanced features to better connect with their visitors.

TAKE AWAY

The project was a great fit for my first, a small UI case study to learn responsive layouts, prototyping, scrolling behavior on a Design in Figma. I realized the importance of user testing surveys, and feedback early in the development process. For the next UI case study, I would like to work with real user data instead of fictional data to create meaningful personas and journeys. Also, I would have liked to have had more time to complete the project with more iterations, to process the feedback I received on the design and features.

HOW USEFUL DO YOU FIND THIS UX CASE STUDY ?
FEEDBACK

Share your thoughts with me

VERONIKA NIKONOVA
FRONTEND & UI DESIGN

GO TO PORTFOLIO